

CURRICULUM VITAE

Colin Xu

Department of Psychology & Communication
University of Idaho

NAME: Colin Xu

UPDATED: September 2025

TITLE: Assistant Professor

DEPARTMENTAL AFFILIATIONS:

Psychology & Communication
Bioinformatics and Computational Biology

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WEBSITE: <https://colinxu5.github.io>

OFFICE ADDRESS: Office 204, 831 Ash St, Moscow, ID 83843

EDUCATION

PhD, Psychology, University of Pennsylvania Advisor: Robert J. DeRubeis Committee: Paul Crits-Christoph, Dianne Chambless Dissertation: <i>Applications of Advanced Statistical Modeling Techniques for Understanding Depression</i>	2022
M.A, Psychology, University of Pennsylvania	2017
B.A, Honours Psychology, University of British Columbia	2015

EXPERIENCE

Academic Appointments:

Assistant Professor, Psychology, University of Idaho	2024 – present
Assistant Professor, Psychology, College of Idaho	2023-2024
Dean's Teaching Fellowship for Excellence, University of Pennsylvania	2022-2023

Consulting:

Statistical Consultant, Restoring Invisible and Abandoned Trials (RIAT) Project. Reanalysis of the Sequenced Treatment Alternatives to Relieve Depression (STAR*D) Study.	2019-2022
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FUNDING

Grants and Contracts Awarded:

Department of Defense (I80VP000641) “Development of Machine Learning Models Utilizing Multimodal Assessments from Smart Wearables for Enhanced PTSD Screening and Precision Diagnosis” Role: Site PI; Co-PIs: Manish Bhomia, Steven P Cohen, Christina Lacroix, Sameer R.	2025-2029
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Sonkusale, CJ Brush

Total project costs: \$4,289,065

Total award amount as site PI: \$974,717

Department of Defense (1I80VP000640)

2025-2028

“Using machine learning to identify factors that increase family risk of dysfunction throughout the deployment cycle”

Role: Site PI; Co-PIs: Beth Hisle-Gorman, Christin Ogle; Co-I's: Steve Cozza

Total project costs : \$1,354,858

Total award amount as site PI: \$361,353

American Psychological Foundation – Walter Katkovsky Research Grant

2018- 2019

“Identifying the contributions of therapeutic processes in combination treatment of antidepressants with cognitive behavioral therapy for depression”

Role: Grant author, PhD research assistant; PI: Robert DeRubeis

Total award amount: \$20,000

Under Review:

2025

National Institutes of Health – CMCI Pilot Grant

“Machine learning models for identifying early warning signs of antidepressant dropout”

Role: PI

Total award amount: \$70,402

Applications – Not Awarded:

Department of Defense (1I80VP000626)

2025

“Machine Learning Methods for Predictors of Post-Deployment Health Outcomes”

Role: Site PI; Co-PIs: Kwang Choi, Jing Wang.

Total amount requested: \$283,249

RESEARCH AND SCHOLARSHIP

Research Focus:

Statistical modeling of psychological disorders including depression, anxiety and PTSD; machine learning for predictive modeling of prognosis and risk; longitudinal and hierarchical modeling; epidemiological and clinical trial data

Peer Reviewed Journal Articles:

(*students mentored by Dr. Xu)

Kim, T. & **Xu, C.** (2025). Do your homework: CT homework compliance predicts next-session depression severity improvement. *Cognitive Therapy and Research*.

Xu, C., Naudet, F., Kim, T. T., Hengartner, M. P., Horowitz, M. A., Kirsch, I., Moncrieff, J., Pigott, E., & Plöderl, M. (2025). Large responses to antidepressants or methodological artifacts? A secondary analysis of STAR*D, a single-arm, open-label, non-industry antidepressant trial. *Journal of Clinical Epidemiology*.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclinepi.2025.111943>

Kim, T., **Xu, C.**, Amsterdam, J. (2025). Comparison of effectiveness and side effects of selegiline

transdermal system versus oral monoamine oxidase inhibitors and tricyclic antidepressants for treatment-resistant depression. *Journal of Affective Disorders*, 376, 47-51
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2025.02.003>

Kim, T. & **Xu, C.** (2024). Not all types of depressed patients who persist with their antidepressant treatment improve in side effect complaints: A comparison of treatment completers and dropouts in the STAR*D trial. *Acta Psychiatrica Scandinavica*, 151(2): 152-162.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/acps.13764>

Amsterdam, J., & **Xu, C.** (2023). Multi-trial, aggregated, individual participant data mega-analysis of short-term antidepressant versus mood stabilizer monotherapy of bipolar type II major depressive episode. *Bipolar Disorders*, 26(3), 255-264. <https://doi.org/10.1111/bdi.13378>

Xu, C., *Miao, L., *Turner, D., & DeRubeis, R. (2023). Urbanicity and depression: A global meta-analysis. *Journal of Affective Disorders*, 340, 299-311.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2023.08.030>

Pigott, H. E., Kim, T., **Xu, C.**, Kirsch, I., & Amsterdam, J. (2023). What are the treatment remission, response and extent of improvement rates after up to four trials of antidepressant therapies in real-world depressed patients? A reanalysis of the STAR* D study's patient-level data with fidelity to the original research protocol. *BMJ open*, 13(7), e063095.
<http://doi.org/10.1136/bmjopen-2022-063095>

Bredemeier, K., Larsen, S., Shivakumar, G., Grubbs, K., McLean, C., Tress, C., Rosenfield, D., DeRubeis, R., **Xu, C.**, Foa, E., Morland, L., Pai, A., Tsao, C., Crawford, J., Weitz, E., Mayinja, L., Feler, B., Wachsman, T., Lupo, M., Hooper, V., ... Thase, M. (2022). A comparison of prolonged exposure therapy, pharmacotherapy, and their combination for PTSD: What works best and for whom; study protocol for a randomized trial. *Contemporary Clinical Trials*, 119, 106850. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cct.2022.106850>

Kim, T. T., **Xu, C.**, & DeRubeis, R. J. (2022). Mapping Female Patients' Judgments of Satisfaction to Hypothetical Changes in Depression Symptom Severity. *Behavior Therapy*, 53(2), 392-399. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.beth.2021.10.003>

Kim, T. T., **Xu, C.**, & Derubeis, R. J. (2022). Patients' judgments of the importance of treatment-induced reductions in symptoms of depression: The role of specific symptoms, magnitudes of change, and post-treatment levels. *Psychotherapy Research*, 32(3), 404-413.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/10503307.2021.1938731>

Xu, C., *Gelberg, H., & DeRubeis, R. J. (2021). Emotion regulation strategy correlates with discrete state emotion in major depression. *Anxiety, Stress, & Coping*, 1-12.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/10615806.2021.2015578>

Khazanov, G. K., **Xu, C.**, Hollon, S. D., DeRubeis, R. J., & Thase, M. E. (2021). Adding cognitive therapy to antidepressant medications decreases suicidal ideation. *Journal of Affective Disorders*, 281, 183-191. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2020.12.032>

DeRubeis, R. J., Zajecka, J., Shelton, R. C., Amsterdam, J. D., Fawcett, J., **Xu, C.**, ... & Hollon, S. D. (2020). Prevention of recurrence after recovery from a major depressive episode with antidepressant medication alone or in combination with cognitive behavioral therapy: a Phase 2 randomized clinical trial. *JAMA Psychiatry*, 77(3), 237-245.
<https://doi.org/10.1001/jamapsychiatry.2019.3900>

Dunn, B. D., German, R. E., Khazanov, G., **Xu, C.**, Hollon, S. D., & DeRubeis, R. J. (2020). Changes in positive and negative affect during pharmacological treatment and cognitive therapy for major depressive disorder: A secondary analysis of two randomized controlled trials. *Clinical Psychological Science*, 8(1), 36-51.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/2167702619863427>

- Khazanov, G. K., **Xu, C.**, Dunn, B. D., Cohen, Z. D., DeRubeis, R. J., & Hollon, S. D. (2020). Distress and anhedonia as predictors of depression treatment outcome: a secondary analysis of a randomized clinical trial. *Behaviour Research and Therapy*, 125, 103507. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.brat.2019.103507>
- Kim, T., Dufour, S., **Xu, C.**, Cohen, Z., Sylvia, L., Deckersbach, T., DeRubeis, R., Nierenberg, A. Predictive modeling for response to lithium and quetiapine in bipolar disorder. (2019). *Bipolar Disorders* 21, 428–436. <https://doi.org/10.1111/bdi.12752>
- Kim, T., **Xu, C.**, Amsterdam, J. D. (2019). Relative effectiveness of tricyclic antidepressant versus monoamine oxidase inhibitor monotherapy for treatment-resistant depression. *Journal of Affective Disorders* 250, 199-203. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jad.2019.03.028>

Book Chapters:

- Fung, K., **Xu, C.**, Glazier, B. L., Parsons, C. A., Alden, L. E. (2016). Research in Clinical Psychology: Social Exclusion in Clinical Samples. P. Riva & J. Eck (Eds.) *Social Exclusion: Psychological Approaches to Understanding and Reducing Its Impact*. Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-33033-4_8

Conference Presentations:

(*students mentored by Dr. Xu)

- Xu, C. *Kim, C., *Candido, K., *Salerni, I., *Ruseva, A. (2024, November). Imposter phenomenology, rejection sensitivity, and reactions to achievement and social failures. Poster presentation at Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies, 2024, Philadelphia, PA.
- Hao, Y., Xu, C., Kweon, H., Farah, M.J. (2023, November). Amygdala reactivity in depression: false positives, states and traits. Poster presentation at Society for Neuroscience Conference 2023, Washington, DC.
- Xu, C., Amsterdam, J. D. (2023, May). Multi-trial, Individual-Participant Data Mega-analysis of Short-term Antidepressant vs. Mood Stabilizer Monotherapy of Bipolar Type II Major Depressive Episode. Poster presented at American Psychiatric Association Annual Meeting 2023, San Francisco, California.
- Xu, C. Kim, T., DeRubeis, R. J. (2022, March). Using Patients' Perspectives to Assess Change, Or Improve the Current Methods in Assessing Change, from Treatment for Depression. Symposium discussion presented at Anxiety and Depression Association of America Conference 2022, Denver, Colorado.
- Xu, C. DeRubeis, R.J. (2018, June). Change in Patient Compensatory Skills in the Prevention of Relapse of Depression. Panel discussion at the North American Society for Psychotherapy Research Conference 2018, Snowbird, Utah.
- Xu, C. DeRubeis, R.J. (2018, June). Measuring clinical change: strengths and limitations of existing methods. Panel discussion presented at Society for Psychotherapy Research Conference 2018, Amsterdam, Netherlands.
- Xu, C. Kim, T., DeRubeis, R.J. (2018, June). A comparison of treatment selection approaches for personalizing treatment for psychological disorders. Brief paper presented at Society for Psychotherapy Research Conference 2018, Amsterdam, Netherlands.
- Xu, C. Kim, T., DeRubeis, R.J. (2018, June). Prognostic modeling versus moderator modeling: A comparison of two methods in generating differential predictions. Poster presented at

Treatment Selection Idea Lab 2018, London, United Kingdom.

Xu, C., DeRubeis, R.J., Hollon, S.D. (2017, June). Changes in Utilization of Different Coping Styles before and after Cognitive Therapy for Depression. Poster presented at Society for Psychotherapy Research Conference 2017, Toronto, ON.

Xu, C., DeRubeis, R.J., Hollon, S.D. (2017, May). Expectations for Treatment in a Trial of Antidepressants vs Combination Therapy: Prediction of Remission and Recovery. Poster presented at Association for Psychological Science Convention 2017, Boston, MA.

Xu, C., Fung, K. Alden, L.E. (2015, May). The effect of 5-HTTLPR and adra2b polymorphisms on emotional recognition ability. Poster presented at Association for Psychological Science Convention 2015, New York, NY.

TEACHING AND SUPERVISION

Courses Taught:

University of Idaho

PSYC 101 – Introduction to Psychology 2025 –

PSYC 311 – Abnormal Psychology 2024 –

The College of Idaho

PSYC 100 – General Psychology 2023-2024

PSYC 370 – Health Psychology 2024

PSYC 400 – Analysis of psychological data 2024

PSYC 404 – Abnormal Psychology 2023

University of Pennsylvania:

PSYC 1462 – Abnormal Psychology 2020-2023

PSYC 4463 – Research Experience in Clinical Psychological Data Analysis 2023

PSYC 3461 – The Science of Depression and Anxiety (Seminar) 2022

Students Advised:

Graduate Committee Member:

University of Idaho

Sara Schumacher (PhD, Nutrition) Ongoing

Maxx Antush (PhD, Movement Sciences) Ongoing

Sharon DeChenne (PhD, Nutrition) Ongoing

Grant Billings (PhD, Psychology) 2025

Independent Study Students:

University of Idaho

Grace Hess 2025-

University of Pennsylvania

Lucille Miao 2018-2021

Devon Turner 2018-2020

Haley Gelberg 2018-2019

Suh Jung (Rylee) Park 2017-2019

Meaghan Lee 2018-2019

Alisia Escobar 2018-2019

Rachel Aboodi	2018
Heejoo Kim	2018
Syed Aajmain	2017-2018
Rigoberto Colon	2017

Honors and Awards:

Dean's Teaching Fellowship for Excellence, University of Pennsylvania, 2022

SERVICE

Departmental committees:

Psychology Department Search Committee, 2025-2026
 Psychology Undergraduate Program Committee, 2025-present
 Psychology Graduate Program Committee, 2024-present
 Communications Program Committee, 2024-2025

Journal Peer Reviewer:

Journal of Psychosomatic Research, 2025
 Journal of Affective Disorders, 2025
 Nature Cities, 2025
 Contemporary Clinical Trials, 2025
 Community Mental Health Journal, 2024
 Nature Scientific Reports, 2024
 Cognitive Therapy and Research, 2023

OUTREACH

Research Outreach / Media Coverage

Simons, Peter. No Subgroup of Patients for Whom Antidepressants Are Effective. *Mad in America*. September 15, 2025. <https://www.madinamerica.com/2025/09/no-subgroup-of-patients-for-whom-antidepressants-are-effective/>

Xu, Colin & Kim, Thomas. No, Your Patients Are Not Wrong: Sometimes Antidepressant Side Effects Do Not Get Better. Cover article in *Psychiatric Times*, 42(4). April 2025. <https://www.psychiatrictimes.com/view/no-your-patients-are-not-wrong-sometimes-antidepressant-side-effects-do-not-get-better>

Dolan, Eric. Study challenges assumption of universal improvement in antidepressant side effects. *Psypost*. November 19, 2024. <https://www.psypost.org/study-challenges-assumption-of-universal-improvement-in-antidepressant-side-effects/>

Wilton, Page. UI professor researches antidepressant side effects. Nov 1, 2024. <https://www.uiargonaut.com/2024/11/01/ui-professor-researches-long-term-antidepressant-side-effects/>

Luten, Christine. U of I researcher challenges beliefs about antidepressant side effects. October 30, 2024. <https://www.uidaho.edu/news/news-articles/news-releases/2024/103024-sideeffects>

Pigott, E., Kim, T., Xu, C., Kirsch, I., Amsterdam, J. "STAR*D's cumulative remission rate and why it

still matters.” Cover article in *Psychiatric Times*, 41 (3). March 2024.
<https://www.psychiatrictimes.com/view/star-d-s-cumulative-remission-rate-and-why-it-still-matters>

Miller, John J. “Exploring the STAR*D Controversy”. Cover article in *Psychiatric Times*, 41 (3). March 2024. <https://www.psychiatrictimes.com/view/exploring-the-star-d-controversy>

Miller, John J. “STAR*D Dethroned?”. Cover article in *Psychiatric Times*, 40 (12). December, 2023. <https://www.psychiatrictimes.com/view/star-d-dethroned>

Moser, Eric. “Five takeaways on urbanicity and depression research.” *Penn Today*. October 25th, 2023.
<https://penntoday.upenn.edu/news/psychology-five-takeaways-urbanicity-and-depression-research>

Borrud, Gabriel & Dillon, Conor. “Sadness and the city”. Interview with Deutsche Welle *Science Unscripted*. September 29, 2023. <https://www.dw.com/en/mental-health-depression-30-more-likely-in-a-city/audio-66952505>

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Certificates:

Proposal Development Academy, University of Idaho,	2025
CETLI Teaching Certificate, Center for Excellence in Teaching, Learning, and Innovation, University of Pennsylvania,	2018